

music connections, and helps book acts for the bar as they try to raise its profile. Amy asks if these parties sometimes get out of control, and Ricky just smiles. Amy groans but says “You’re hired” and Colin is underway.

Dan asks if Meg has a concept, but hers is still coming together, so he describes his character: Lucky, a fox pooka and successful local entrepreneur who still hasn’t forgotten his roots as a small-time con man and hustler. He sees Lucky as a regular of the bar rather than an employee, somebody who steers business their way from time to time, and intends to take some serious Resources and other Backgrounds to reflect the pooka’s status as a wealthy patron. Lucky may also serve as a narrative way to pool Backgrounds later on, since he’s the wealthiest and most established of the characters, as well as bring in some interesting underworld subplots if his past comes back to haunt him.

With the rest of the group feeling confident in their concepts, Meg finalizes her character. Sure, Harper is the owner and the face of the operation, Colin handles the talent, and Lucky brings in customers (while running up a tab), but they need someone who makes all these grand ideas actually work. Meg says that she’ll play Saffron, Saffie to her friends, a boggan grump who balances the books, supervises the supply orders, manages the staff, and otherwise finds joy in keeping the place running day to day. It may not be the most high-profile job, but that’s exactly how boggans like it!

When it comes to picking seemings, Amy and Dan both feel their characters are wilders, always looking for the next challenge (or the next score). Meg settles on grump, feeling it reflects Saffron’s steady personality and love of creating and sustaining projects. Everyone expects Ricky’s character Colin to be a wilder as well, given his hard-partying persona, but he decides that childling actually suits the character better—Colin has a wide-eyed innocence about the world and especially his changeling nature that informs his behavior.

Courts and Legacies are the last element at this stage. Amy, Ricky, and Meg are all leaning toward the Seelie Court, though Ricky decides that Colin began as Unseelie but shifted after a major event early in his changeling life. To no one’s particular surprise, Dan announces that Lucky is definitely Unseelie, which Pete feels adds a fresh perspective and a nice element of unpredictability to the group.

As far as Legacies are concerned, Meg immediately hones in on Sage for Saffie’s Seelie side, as she feels the boggan is especially at home giving advice and enjoys helping others succeed. An Unseelie Legacy proves a bit trickier, as she is torn between Pandora and Riddler, but ultimately decides that Pandora is a bit more appropriate given Saffie’s curious nature. Given how many secrets people share with Saffron, the idea of her Unseelie nature coming to the fore can unleash serious relationship chaos, which Meg finds a wonderful roleplaying opportunity.

Attributes

With basic concepts handled, everyone settles in to start selecting Traits on the character sheets to flesh out how their characters are realized in the game world. Seeing that the

group has a strong social base, but not seeing Saffie as being particularly physically inclined, Meg decides to prioritize her Attribute categories as follows: Mental, Social, Physical.

As a bookkeeper and organizational whiz, Saffie will need a solid Intelligence score, so Meg puts two of her seven points there. Like a lot of boggans, Saffie is good at picking up subtle cues and hints, so Meg puts three points in Perception. She toys with putting another point in Intelligence, but ultimately decides that Saffie is well-rounded intellectually, so her final two points go into Wits. Not much gets past this boggan!

While she might not be a party animal like Colin or a skilled schmoozer like Lucky, Saffie is still good with people in her own way, and the group decides that the staff adores her because she is good at noticing when they need help and is sympathetic to their problems. Meg has five points to put in this category, so she decides to put two points each into Charisma and Manipulation. Saffie is naturally charming and good with words in her own quiet way. Her final point goes into Appearance—Meg declares that Saffie is pretty cute but doesn’t put much effort into her looks, despite Harper’s best efforts to style her and update her wardrobe.

Physical Traits are the last category, and with only three points to allocate here, Meg decides to go with one point each for Strength, Dexterity, and Stamina. Saffie is in average shape, her morning workout offset a bit by being behind a desk a lot in the back office.

Abilities

As Meg moves on to Abilities, she asks around to see what the rest of the group is thinking. Dan says that Lucky is going to focus on a “criminal” skill set, while Colin has a mix of athletics and socializing, and Harper is going for a leadership role with a background in hands-on technical skills. Given her role as the organizational glue of the group, and Meg’s vision of Saffie as a bit of bookworm, she decides to prioritize her Abilities as follows: Knowledges, Talents, Skills.

With 13 points to distribute, Knowledges seems like a deep field, but Meg knows those points will go quickly. She allocates two to Academics, reflecting Saffie’s classical liberal arts education. Meg also decides Saffie’s curiosity make her a puzzle enthusiast, so three points go into Enigmas, and since her Chrysalis she’s studied a bit about Kithain lore as well, earning two points of Gremayre. She toys with putting points in Computers, but decides that Saffie is pretty traditional and uses old-fashioned ledgers and paper records, sometimes to the frustration of the staff and the bar’s vendors. Meg asks Pete if Expert Knowledge: Finance would be acceptable, and he agrees, so she puts three points into it, making Saffie quite talented at managing money. Two of her remaining points go into Investigation, reflecting her research skills, while her final point goes into Law, mostly gained from hanging around Lucky (and cleaning up after Colin’s parties).

Talents come up next, with nine points to allocate. Even though the group is already leaning heavily into social skills, Meg asks the others what they’re planning and finds there’s still room for Saffie to be distinctive here. She puts three points into